Internally too, the IAF was concerned that it would be 'eclipsed' by the much larger Indian Army in the ITCs, or worse, relegated into operating—as General Rawat had declared—as the Army's 'back-up or supplementary force'.[18] In fact, at one stage, even the use of the word 'integrated' was debated, so intense were the deliberations. As a way out of the impasse, I suggested that we needed to test the efficacy of the model through the medium of a war game, and this would only be successful if all the Services sent their representatives of sufficient seniority. Accordingly, HQ SWC was tasked to conduct the same at a convenient time and place.

SWC held a joint Theatre-Level War Game based on a tactical scenario of the Western Front. It was attended by all the Army Commanders facing the Western Front, as well as Army Commander Central Command along with their senior staff officers. From the Army HQ, the DGMO and DG PP attended on all days, while I went on the last day and a half. The Navy sent a comparatively junior officer, understandably so, more as an observer than a participant as they had little or no operational role as part of LTC (W). From the Air Force side, apart from the Air Force officers who are integral to the Command and Corps HQ, only the AD Cdrs of WAC and SWAC were present, as was the AOC-in-C, WAC. Lt Gen Bhinder had conducted the war game in a most professional and visionary manner, wearing the hat of a 'Theatre Commander', and I must say that the role suited him. Among the outcomes, it once again emerged that a Theatre needed to be self-contained in all respects, with all resources integral to its ORBAT. Some reserves or critical high-value assets could be retained centrally to be released on the directions of the COSC. For example, the Armoured Division of 1 Corps (reassigned to Northern Command less its Armoured Division) could become

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